



Fashion meets technology

Jackets by Paul&Shark have pockets lined with stainless steel fibres that create a protective shield against electromagnetic waves <http://dgit.in/PSEMWS>

Ireland human history

New discoveries suggest human presence on the island from as far back as 12000 B.C <http://dgit.in/IrishMan>

Smartwatches

HOW WE TESTED

Testing smartwatches can be tricky. It's one thing to compare looks and design, but that may differ from person to person. What you think looks good, may not be the same as what we think. Nevertheless, the looks for a smartwatch does play a very big role in its success. After all, there is a big fashion play here.

There is more to it though. A smartwatch also wants to be your fitness tracker, which means that accuracy is of paramount importance. We tested the tracking capabilities of each of these devices.

Then again, smartwatches also have some similarities with phones. Things like processor speed, RAM, pixel density of their displays, were also considered. Waterproofing is an important element, which means a watch that is completely waterproof will be more useful than one

that is only water resistant. Add to that the weight of each watch. All these features were taken into consideration.

For performance, we tested the time each smartwatch took to display notifications. Some took a few seconds too long to detect calls and texts, which is often the difference between pulling your phone out of the pocket and using your smartwatch to respond. Also, while Apple's Watch OS works well with iOS, Google's Android Wear is also designed to be in sync with Android. In future, this could be a problem for operating systems like Tizen and Pebble OS, which have to walk the extra mile in order to achieve the same speed and fluidity. Speaking of which, the intuitiveness of the OS was also noted, along with the ecosystem it tries to provide for added functionality.

Lastly, having reviewed all of these smartwatches and used them ourselves, we had a good sense of how long their batteries last. However, for a more objective approach, we made equal number of calls and text messages to each of these and noted the battery drop. Few smartwatches can boast battery life of over a day and a half today, which is something that companies really need to solve.

With all this done, the price element was brought into play, in order to identify which watch made for the best value for money and bag our Best Buy award.

Our selections were the most talked about smartwatches today, which made for a great battle. We had the Apple Watch, Samsung Gear S2, Moto 360 (2nd Gen), Asus Zenwatch 2 and the Pebble Time.

how fast it responds to calls or texts that you receive.

There's an interesting note here, while Android Wear and WatchOS devices respond faster to native Android apps, like Google Messenger etc, they're slower in responding to texts on WhatsApp and other third party apps. The Pebble Time however, takes the same time to respond to all applications that it supports.

The problem with the Pebble Time is that it costs nearly ₹20,000, which is a lot considering its other problems. The lack of intuitiveness, a heart rate sensor and the inaccuracy in steps-tracking are major inhibitors for it. While the Pebble Time definitely has potential, there's still more to do for the company.

APPLE WATCH

An interesting thing happened while writing down this comparison. On the day we sat down to write this, Apple decided to drop the price of the Apple Watch in the US. It currently costs about \$300 there,

but unfortunately, at the time of print, the India pricing was still upwards of ₹40,000.

Now the Apple Watch played an interesting role here. On the one hand, the device has a really premium metal build, but our judgements on its design are divided. So, we'll leave the decision of whether the Apple Watch really looks good, to you.

The redeeming qualities of the Apple Watch though, like firstly in its display. It has a 1.65 inch display, with an incredible 303 ppi pixel density. Barring the Samsung Gear S2, the Apple Watch may very well have the highest pixel density amongst smartwatches today. In addition, like most Apple displays, this one also looks very good.

But while the Apple Watch has a really good display, its other features and performance barely justify the price. For one, like most Apple devices in the past, this one also can't go past a full day's battery life. In fact, even that depends on how many notifications you usu-

ally get. In addition, Apple's Watch OS isn't the most intuitive either. It tries to replicate iOS in some ways, while adding the crown has made it easier to navigate than many other smartwatches.

Having said that, the crown still isn't the best way to navigate and there are places where the Apple Watch just isn't the best in the market. The good part is that there are quite a

few apps to use with it, but like most other smartwatches, they're not the most useful. In addition, while the Apple Watch isn't completely accurate in tracking your steps, in our tests it turned out to be the most accurate amongst these competitors.

It also works only with iPhones, meaning it makes no sense unless you own Apple's premiere device. SO, all things



Samsung Gear S2